

December

6

343 CE

Saint Nicholas

The patron saint of children and sailors, Saint Nicholas, is believed to have died on this day. Christians celebrate this annual date as St Nicholas Day.



1913 Finding Nefertiti

More than 3,000 years after it was created, a bust of the Egyptian queen Nefertiti was found by German archaeologist Ludwig Borchardt in the city of Amarna, Egypt. It was buried under rubble at the site of the ancient workshop of the royal sculptor Thutmose.



Born this day

1977 Andrew Flintoff, British cricketer. A great player of the game, he won an MBE from Queen Elizabeth II for his services to cricket before retiring to become a television presenter.

Also on this day

1884 Construction of the Washington Monument was completed. It was built to honour George Washington, the first president of the USA.

1921 The Anglo-Irish Treaty was signed by the British government and Irish leaders to end the Irish War of Independence. It led to the establishment of the Irish Free State a year later.

2017 The discovery of the most distant supermassive black hole ever recorded, with a mass 800 million times greater than the Sun, was reported in the journal *Nature*.

1892

Nutcracker premiere

The first performance of the ballet *The Nutcracker*, created by Russian composer Pyotr Ilyich Tchaikovsky, was held in Saint Petersburg, Russia. The fairytale story was based on German author E T A Hoffmann's classic Christmas story for children.

